Topic 3 — Regional Kingdoms (Sharqi (शर्की), Kashmir, Vijayanagara (विजयनगर), Bahmani & Deccan (दक्कन))

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Sharqi Sultanate (Jaunpur (जौनपुर)) | Kashmir under Zain-ul-Abidin (ज़ैन-उल-आबिदीन) | Gujarat Sultanate (quick) | Vijayanagara Empire (विजयनगर) | Bahmani Kingdom (बहमनी) | Deccan Sultanates | Battle of Talikota

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, **Ghatnachakra** Provincial Dynasties of North India & Deccan (B–253+), UPPCS / UKPCS Prelims PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ — Sharqi architecture (UP), Zain-ul-Abidin tolerance, Vijayanagara–Bahmani rivalry, Talikota, Deccan capitals, book–context matching **Last verified:** September 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical)

3.1 Sharqi Sultanate (Jaunpur)

Period: ~1394–1479/1484 | Capital: Jaunpur (eastern UP) | **Founder of state: Malik Sarwar**

- **Firuz Shah Tughlaq** founded the **city of Jaunpur** in memory of his cousin **Jauna Khan** (**Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक)).
- Under late Tughlaq weakness (**Mahmud Shah II** era, **~1394**), **Malik Sarwar** (a slave of that court) became independent. Delhi gave him titles **Malik-us-Sharq** (Lord of the East) and **Khwaja-i-Jahan**.
- He and his adopted (अंगीकृत) line founded the **Sharqi** dynasty. Independence lasted about **85 years**.
- The Sharqi core lay in **eastern UP** (Jaunpur–Ghazipur–Banaras); claims ran wider from Aligarh (अलीगढ़) toward Darbhanga.
- **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (1402–1440)** was the greatest Sharqi ruler. **Sharqi style** architecture flowered; Jaunpur was called **Siraj-i-Hind / Shiraz-i-Hind** (Shiraz of the East) as a learning and culture centre.
- **Vidyapati** described Jaunpur and Ibrahim Shah in *Kirtilata*.
- **Mubarak Shah** followed Malik Sarwar; later **Mahmud Shah** faced Lodi pressure.
- **Hussain Shah** was the last Sharqi sultan. **Bahlul Lodi** defeated him and reattached Jaunpur to Delhi (**1479** in Ghatnachakra; many coaching keys also use **1484**).
- Monuments: **Atala Masjid**, **Lal Darwaza Masjid**, **Jami Masjid (Jaunpur)** — massive gateways and arches.
- **Malik Muhammad Jaisi** composed **Padmavat** in this cultural circle.

Logic: Siraj-e-Hind is true because Jaunpur was a great education and culture centre under the Sharqis (**UP R.O./A.R.O. 2023** — both true, R explains A).

> **Logic:** Lal Darwaza–Jaunpur is **correct**. Do not confuse it with **Tin Darwaza–Ahmedabad**: Tin Darwaza stands at **Bidar Fort**, while Ahmedabad has **Teen Darwaza**. Among Topic-3 states, only **Sharqi Jaunpur** lies in modern **Uttar Pradesh**.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q19]: Adina Masjid** is at **Pandua (Bengal)** built by Sikandar Shah, NOT at Mandu (MP). Lal Darwaza Masjid & Atala Masjid are in Jaunpur; Dakhil Darwaza is in Bengal. *(See Q1 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q91) Arrange the following in chronological order:

I. Rabia Daurani Tomb

II. Sher Shah (शेरशाह) Tomb

III. Humayun (हुमायूँ) Tomb

IV. Atala Mosque Jaunpur

A. I, II, IV, III B. IV, II, III, I C. III, II, I, IV D. IV, III, I, II

Show answer

Ans: B (IV, II, III, I). **Order:** IV **Atala Mosque, Jaunpur** (~**15th c.**, Sharqi) → II **Sher Shah's Tomb, Sasaram (सासाराम)** (**1545**) → III **Humayun's Tomb, Delhi** (**1565**) → I **Rabia Daurani's Tomb, Aurangabad** (**1678**). **Trap:** Do not place **Humayun** before **Sher Shah** (शेरशाह) — Sher Shah died and was buried **20 years earlier**. Atala is **not** Mughal (मुग़ल); it belongs to the **Sharqi** phase.

3.2 Kashmir under Zain-ul-Abidin

Reign:1420–1470 | **Capital:Srinagar** | **Title:Bud Shah** (Great Sultan) | **Also called:** Akbar (अकबर) of Kashmir

- Original name **Shahi Khan**; he sat on the Kashmir throne after his brother Ali Shah.
- His predecessor **Sikandar Shah (1389–1413)** had forced conversions, destroyed temples, and allowed cow slaughter under **Suha Bhatt**.
- **Zain-ul-Abidin (1420–1470)** reversed Sikandar's intolerant policies and earned the title **Bud Shah**. He is also remembered as the **Akbar of Kashmir** for liberal religion, learning, and crafts.
- He **abolished jaziya** and banned cow slaughter.
- He **restored temples** and permitted reconversion to Hinduism.
- He appointed **Sriya Bhatt** as Minister of Justice and court physician.
- He patronised learning in **Persian (फ़ारसी), Kashmiri, Sanskrit, and Tibetan**.
- He commissioned translations of the **Mahabharata** (महाभारत) and **Rajatarangini** (राजतरंगिणी).

- He promoted **shawl weaving**, papermaking, and other crafts.
- He built dams, canals, and **Zaina Lanka**, an island in **Wular Lake**.
- He defeated the Ladakh (लद्दाख) Mongols and expanded influence over Baltistan, Jammu, and Rajauri.

> **Logic: Zain-ul-Abidin (Bud Shah)** alone abolished **jaziya** and banned **cow slaughter** in Kashmir.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [Kashmir — Zain-ul-Abidin]:** Zain-ul-Abidin (*Bud Shah*, 1420–1470) reversed Sikandar Shah's iconoclastic policies, abolished **Jizya** and **cow slaughter**, built the island **Zaina Lanka** in Wular lake, and commissioned the translation of *Rajatarangini* and *Mahabharata* into Persian. *(See Q6 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q36]:** Ruler of Kashmir who abolished Jizya and cow slaughter was **Zain-ul-Abidin**. *(See Q6 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

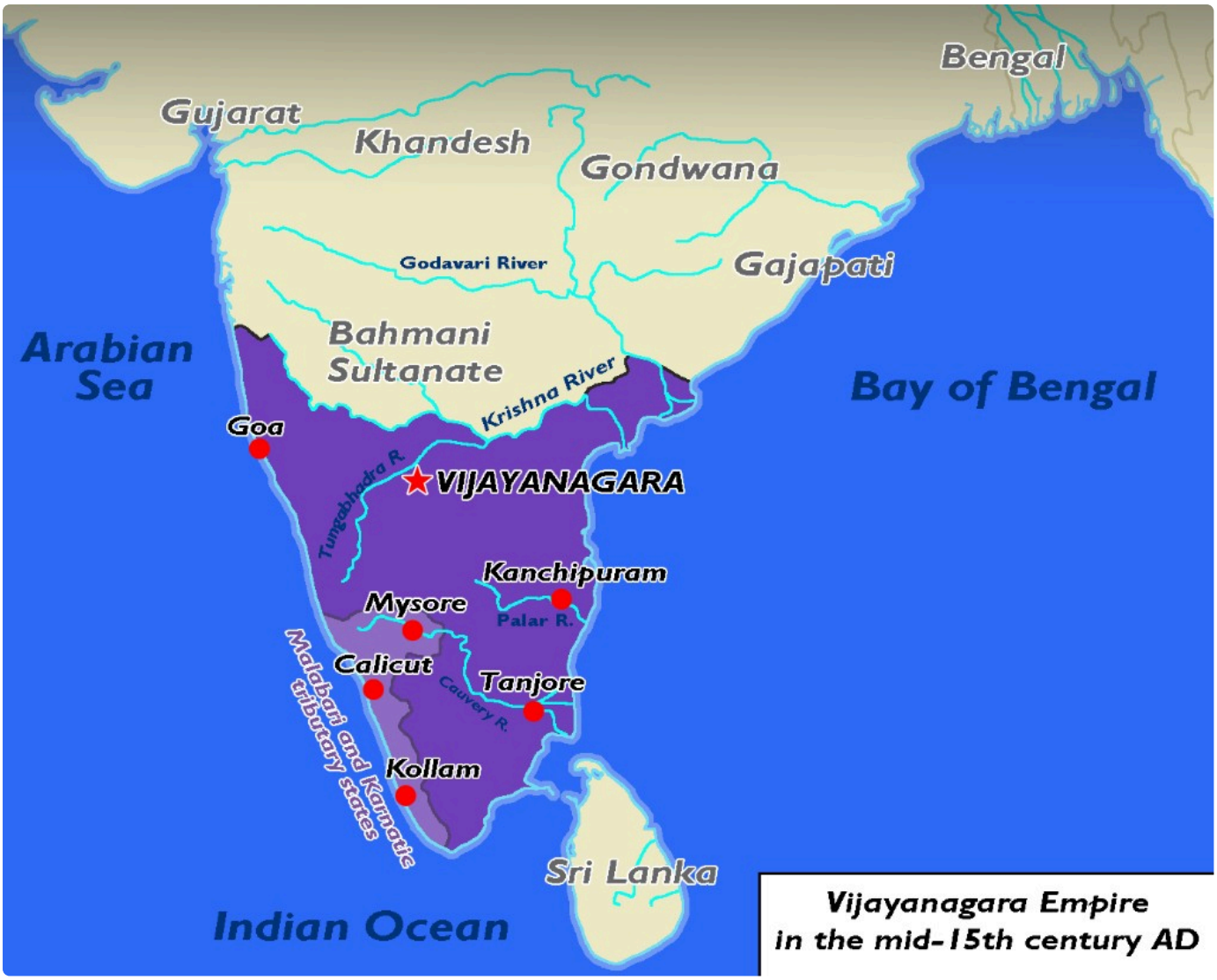
3.2a Gujarat Sultanate

Independent Gujarat | Muzaffar Shah line | Champaner–Girnar fame

- Under late Tughlaq weakness, **Zafar (ज़फ़र) Khan** took the title **Muzaffar Shah** in **1407** and founded independent Gujarat.
- He defeated **Hoshang Shah** of Malwa, briefly held **Dhar**, then restored Malwa rather than annexing it permanently.
- **Mahmud Begada** (born **Fateh Khan**, ruling from **1458**; title **Abul Fateh Mahmud**) is the famous later Gujarat sultan.
- His headline victories are the forts of **Champaner** and **Girnar**.
- **Bahadur Shah** later allowed the **Portuguese** a fort at **Diu** by the **1535** treaty against Mughal danger, then regretted the concession.
- The chronicle **Mirat-e-Sikandari** is the Gujarat victory narrative used in book-context match stems.
- Do not relocate Gujarat's capital story to **Ahmadabad-only** memory when the stem asks Begada's fort victories — Champaner and Girnar are the keys.

3.3 Vijayanagara Empire

Founded 1336 | Founders Harihara I and Bukka I (Sangama) | **Capital Hampi** on the Tungabhadra



Dynasty	Key rulers	Period
Sangama	Harihara I, Bukka I, Deva Raya II	1336–1485
Saluva	Saluva Narasimha	1485–1505
Tuluva	**Krishnadevaraya**, Achyuta Raya	1505–1570
Aravidu	Tirumala, Venkata II	1570–1646

- Harihara I and Bukka I founded Vijayanagara in response to **Delhi Sultanate** (दिल्ली सल्तनत) expansion under **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** and wider Deccan instability.
- Vijayanagara fought chronic wars with the **Bahmani Kingdom** over the **Raichur doab (दोआब)** between the Krishna (कृष्णा) and Tungabhadra rivers.
- The empire reached its peak under **Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529)**.
- Decline accelerated under the regency of **Aliya Rama Raya**.
- After **Talikota in 1565**, Hampi was sacked and the **Aravidu** dynasty ruled a diminished kingdom from **Penukonda and Chandragiri**.
- Foreign travellers **Nuniz**, **Paes**, and **Duarte Barbosa** describe Hampi's wealth.

- Major Hampi monuments include the **Vitthala Temple**, **Virupaksha** (विरूपाक्ष), and **Hazara Rama** temples.

Rulers and dynasties

Harihara I (1336–1356, Sangama)

- **Harihara I** and his brother **Bukka I** founded Vijayanagara at **Hampi** in **1336** after Delhi Sultanate pressure under **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**.
- Harihara had earlier served the **Kampili** kingdom and the **Hoysala** network before building an independent Hindu power in the Tungabhadra–Krishna zone.

Bukka I (1356–1377, Sangama)

- **Bukka I** consolidated the infant kingdom and strengthened Sangama authority over the core Kannada–Telugu belt.
- He continued temple patronage and frontier wars that fixed Vijayanagara as a permanent Deccan power.

Harihara II (1377–1404, Sangama)

- **Harihara II** extended Vijayanagara influence deeper into the **Tamil** country and the eastern coast.
- His reign saw the empire grow from a regional kingdom into a wider southern state.

Deva Raya I (1406–1422, Sangama)

- **Deva Raya I** rebuilt royal power after a brief internal crisis in the Sangama line.
- He fought the **Bahmanis** and restored Vijayanagara prestige in the **Raichur doab**.

Deva Raya II (1424–1446, Sangama)

- **Deva Raya II** was the greatest **pre-Tuluva** Vijayanagara ruler and is remembered as **Praudha Deva Raya**.
- He earned the title **Gajabetekara** (elephant hunter) and repeatedly defeated Bahmani armies in the Krishna–Tungabhadra belt.
- He patronised **Sanskrit** and **Telugu** learning and sent embassies to **Sri Lanka** and the **Far East**.
- His death in **1446** opened a phase of noble factionalism that weakened the Sangama line.

Saluva Narasimha (1485–1490, Saluva)

- **Saluva Narasimha** ended Sangama rule by seizing the throne in **1485** after prolonged ministerial and noble struggles.
- He began the short **Saluva** dynasty and tried to recentre authority in the hands of the king.

Narasimha Raya II (1491–1505, Saluva)

- **Narasimha Raya II** was a weak Saluva ruler under powerful nobles.
- His reign prepared the ground for the **Tuluva** seizure of power under **Vira Narasimha** and then **Krishnadevaraya**.

Achyuta Raya (1529–1542, Tuluva)

- **Achyuta Raya** was **Krishnadevaraya's** younger brother and succeeded him in **1529**.

- His reign saw court rivalry and the rise of the **Aravidu** and **Tirumala** factions.

Sadasiva Raya (1542–1570, Tuluva)

- **Sadasiva Raya** ruled in name while **Aliya Rama Raya** acted as the real regent.
- This regency period ended with the fatal overreach that produced the **Talikota** disaster.

Aliya Rama Raya (regent, killed 1565)

- **Rama Raya** was the dominant minister-regent who repeatedly interfered in Deccan Sultanate successions.
- His policy united **Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golkonda, and Bidar** against Vijayanagara at **Talikota (1565)**.
- He was **captured and beheaded** on the battlefield, and Hampi was sacked.

Tirumala Raya & Venkata II (Aravidu, post-1565)

- After **Talikota**, the **Aravidu** line ruled a reduced kingdom from **Penukonda** and later **Chandragiri**.
- **Venkata II** tried to recover prestige, but Vijayanagara never regained its pre-1565 imperial reach.
- The dynasty survived in name until **1646**, long after Hampi was abandoned.

Administration

Nayankara/amara system | **Rajya** provinces | **Mahanavami** royal festival

Office / unit	Function
Mahapradhana	Prime minister; headed the central council
Dandanayaka	Law, order, and military coordination
Rajya	Province under a governor
Nadu (नाडु)	District cluster below the province
Ur	Ordinary village assembly
Sabha (सभा)	Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) **agrahara** assembly with stronger autonomy
Nayaka (नायक)	Feudatory holder of an **amaram** grant
Amaram	Land grant tied to military service

- The king acted as **dharma protector** and commander-in-chief, assisted by a cabinet of great officers whose titles varied by period.
- Under the **nayankara/amara system**, the king granted **amaram lands** to **nayakas** in return for **military service**, tribute, and local administration.
- A **nayaka** maintained troops, collected revenue from his grant, and owed feudatory duty to the Vijayanagara throne.
- This system later became the precursor to post-1565 **Nayak kingdoms** such as **Madurai** (मदुरै), **Tanjore** (तंजावुर), and **Gingee**.

- **Land revenue** was the main income, drawn from temple lands (**devadana**), **agrahara** grants, and peasant holdings.
- The state also drew income from **customs**, **monopolies**, and tribute presented at royal festivals.
- The army (सेना) included **elephants, cavalry, infantry, and artillery** by the sixteenth century.
- The **Portuguese** at **Goa** (गोवा) supplied horses and firearms to Vijayanagara in Krishnadevaraya's age.
- The **Mahanavami/Dasara** festival at Hampi was a royal display of power, tribute collection, and military might.
- Temple grants were recorded on **mandapa (मंडप) pillars** at **Virupaksha** and **Vitthala**.

Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529)

- In the **Battle of Raichur (1520)** (रायचूर), he defeated **Ismail Adil Shah** of Bijapur and captured Raichur fort, marking his military peak.
- He also defeated **Prataparudra** of Orissa/Gajapati and secured the Krishna boundary.
- He used **Portuguese** contacts to obtain horses and guns.
- He authored **Amuktamalyada**, a Telugu epic.
- He patronised the **Ashtadiggajas**, the eight great Telugu poets at his court.
- **Allasani Peddana** wrote **Manucharitramu** and served at Krishnadevaraya's court.
- **Tenali Ramakrishna (रामकृष्ण)** was another famous courtier of Krishnadevaraya.
- He was personally devoted to **Vaishnavism** (वैष्णव), but he also patronised **Shaiva** temples.
- He died in **1529**, and his brother **Achyuta Raya** succeeded him.
- Later, the **Rama Raya** regency led the empire toward Talikota.

> **Logic:** The founders of Vijayanagara were **Harihara I and Bukka I**, not Krishnadevaraya. The **nayankara** system belongs to **Vijayanagara**, not to the Delhi **iqta** or the Mughal **jagir** (जागीर). **Amuktamalyada** was written by Krishnadevaraya in Telugu; **Kitab-i-Nauras** was written by **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of Bijapur.

3.3.1 High-Yield Fact-Locks — Vijayanagara Empire (Ghatnachakra Master Spine)

1. **Founding & Reconversion:** Founded in **1336 CE** on the south bank of Tungabhadra by brothers **Harihara I and Bukka I** (sons of Sangama). Originally ministers of Kampili; captured by Muhammad bin Tughluq and converted to Islam; reconverted to Hinduism under the spiritual guidance of **Sage Vidyaranya** and his brother **Sayana** (the great Vedic commentator). First capital was **Anegundi**, later shifted to **Vidyanagara / Vijayanagara (Hampi)**.
2. **Four Successive Dynasties:** - **Sangama Dynasty (1336–1485):** Harihara I, Bukka I (sent embassy to Ming China in 1374), Harihara II (first to adopt imperial title *Maharajadhiraja* and conquer Goa/Canara), Devaraya I, Devaraya II (*Praudha Deva Raya*, title *Gajabetekara*). - **Saluva Dynasty (1485–1505):** Founded by **Saluva Narasimha** (*First Usurpation / Prathama Balapaharana* to save the empire from disintegration). - **Tuluva Dynasty (1505–1570):** Founded by **Vira Narasimha** (*Second Usurpation / Dvitiya Balapaharana*); reached golden age under **Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529)**; followed by Achyuta Raya (1529–1542) and Sadasiva Raya (1542–1570, puppet under regent

Aliya Rama Raya). - **Aravidu Dynasty (1570–1649):** Founded by **Tirumala Raya** (brother of Rama Raya); shifted capital to **Penukonda**, later **Chandragiri**, and finally **Vellore**.

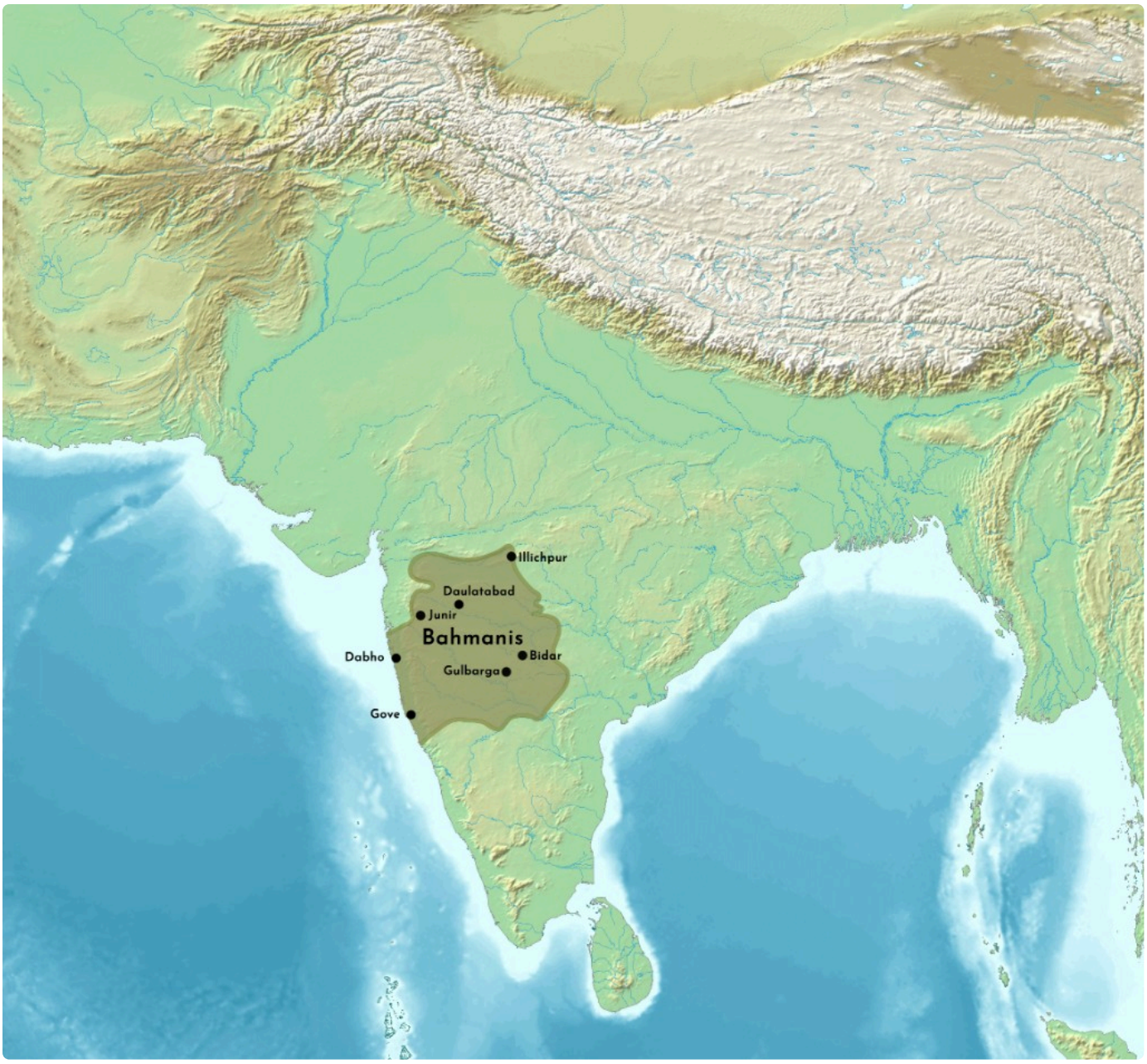
3. **Foreign Travellers Chronology Matrix (★★★ High-Yield PCS Trap):** - **Nicolo de Conti (Italy, 1420 CE):** Visited under **Devaraya I**; recorded city perimeter of 60 miles and grand celebrations of Navaratri and Deepavali. - **Abdur Razzaq (Persia/Herat, 1443 CE):** Ambassador of Timurid ruler Shahrukh to the court of **Devaraya II**; wrote: *"The city of Bijanagar is such that the pupil of the eye has never seen a place like it..."*; described **7 concentric circles of fortified walls** enclosing agricultural fields and orchards. - **Afanasy Nikitin (Russia, 1470 CE):** Visited Bahmani/Deccan; recorded poverty of peasants alongside royal luxury. - **Duarte Barbosa (Portugal, 1516 CE):** Visited under **Krishnadevaraya**; praised trade and complete religious tolerance. - **Domingo Paes (Portugal, 1520 CE):** Visited under **Krishnadevaraya**; described Krishnadevaraya as the most perfect, feared, and gallant king; provided eye-witness accounts of the **Mahanavami Dibba**. - **Fernao Nuniz (Portugal, 1535 CE):** Horse-trader who spent 3 years under **Achyuta Deva Raya**; chronicled the history of all earlier kings; uniquely recorded that **women in Vijayanagara were employed as wrestlers, astrologers, accountants, music masters, and armed royal bodyguards**. - **Cesare Federici (Italy, 1567 CE):** Visited Hampi 2 years after Talikota; recorded its total desolation.
4. **Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529 CE) — Zenith of Empire:** - **Titles:** *Andhra Bhoja*, *Abhinava Bhoja*, *Yavana-rajya-sthapana-acharya* (Restorer of the Bahmani/Yavana kingdom after reinstating Mahmud Shah at Bidar). - **Chief Minister / Advisor: Timmarusu** (affectionately called *Appaji*). - **Military Exploits:** Captured Udayagiri (1514) and Kondavidu from Gajapati ruler Prataparudra of Orissa; decisively defeated Ismail Adil Shah of Bijapur in the **Battle of Raichur (1520)**. - **City Foundation:** Founded the suburban city of **Nagalapuram** near Vijayanagara in honour of his mother **Nagala Devi**. Built the **Hazara Rama Temple** and **Vitthala Temple** (with 56 musical pillars) at Hampi. - **Diplomacy:** Maintained friendly alliance with Portuguese Governor **Afonso de Albuquerque**, securing a royal monopoly on imported Persian and Arabian war-horses. - **Literature:** Authored the celebrated Telugu masterpiece on statecraft **Amuktamalyada** (The Giver of Worn Garlands; centered on Andal / Vishnuchitta) and the Sanskrit drama **Jambavati Kalyanam**. - **Ashtadiggajas (Eight Celebrated Telugu Poets):** Allasani Peddana (*Andhra Kavita Pitamaha*, author of *Manucharitramu*), Nandi Timmana (*Parijatapaharanamu*), Tenali Ramakrishna (*Panduranga Mahatmyamu*), Madayyagari Mallana, Dhurjati, Ayyalaraju Ramabhadrudu, Pingali Surana, and Ramarajabhushanudu.
5. **Battle of Talikota / Rakshasi-Tangadi / Bannihatti (23 January 1565):** - **The Confederacy:** United alliance of 4 Deccan Sultanates: **Bijapur** (Ali Adil Shah I), **Ahmadnagar** (Hussain Nizam Shah I), **Golkonda** (Ibrahim Qutb Shah), and **Bidar** (Ali Barid Shah). - **The Excluded State (★★★ Repeated Exam Trap): Berar (Imad Shahi)** did NOT join the anti-Vijayanagara league due to fierce bilateral conflict with Ahmadnagar. - **Outcome:** Regent **Aliya Rama Raya** (nearly 80 years old) was captured and beheaded on the battlefield by Hussain Nizam Shah I. The victorious Muslim armies sacked, looted, and burned Hampi for over five months.
6. **Vijayanagara Coinage:** - Standard gold coin: **Varaha** (weighed ~52 grains; called **Pagoda** by European travellers, or *Hun* in the Deccan). - Depictions on gold coins: Shiva-Parvati, Venkateshvara, Lakshmi-Narayana, or the mythical double-headed giant eagle **Gandabherunda**. - Fractions of Varaha: **Pratapa** (1/2 Varaha), **Fanam** (1/10th or 1/20th Varaha). - Copper coin: **Jital** or **Tare**.
7. **Provincial & Village Administration:** - **Nayankara System:** Royal military chiefs (**Amara-nayakas**) were granted territories (**Amaram**) in lieu of salary and maintenance of fixed contingents of foot-soldiers, horses, and elephants. Nayakas paid an annual tribute and attended the king during wars

and royal festivities (Mahanavami). - **Ayagar System:** Every village was an autonomous administrative unit governed by **12 hereditary functionaries (Ayagars)**, including the *Karnam* (village accountant), *Talari* (village watchman/police), and *Gauda* (headman). They were remunerated by tax-free land assignments called **Manyam**.

8. **Revenue & Taxes:** - Land revenue called **Shist** (assessed by the revenue department **Athavana**). Standard tax was 1/6th of produce, though wet land rates could rise to 1/3rd or 1/2. - **Marriage Tax (Kalyana-kanikkai):** Levied on both bride and groom; Krishnadevaraya officially abolished the marriage tax to alleviate social hardship.
9. **Social Life & Women's Status:** - Women occupied a remarkable diversity of public and court positions: acted as **wrestlers**, **palace guards**, **astrologers**, **accountants**, **clerks**, **musicians**, and **poets** (e.g., Gangadevi, wife of Kumara Kampana, who authored *Madhura Vijayam* celebrating the conquest of Madurai; Tirumalamba, author of *Varadambika Parinayam*). - Sati (*Sahagamana*) and Devadasi systems were prevalent.
10. **Post-Talikota Capitals:**
    - Tirumala shifted the royal seat to **Penukonda** (1567–1592); Venkata II shifted to **Chandragiri** (1592–1604) and later **Vellore**. In 1639, British factor Francis Day acquired Madras (Fort St. George) from Damarla Venkatadri Nayaka, a vassal of Vijayanagara King Venkata III at Chandragiri.

3.4 Bahmani Kingdom

Founded: 1347 | **Founder: Hasan Gangu** (throne name **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah**) | **Capitals: Gulbarga (Ahsanabad)**, then **Bidar**



- Bahmani rose during **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**'s Deccan turmoil after the **Amiran-e-Sadah** rebellions.
- **Zafar Khan / Hasan Gangu** declared independence at **Gulbarga** in **1347**, took the title **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah**, and named the capital **Ahsanabad**.
- Early rule divided the realm into four (चातुर्याम) provinces: **Gulbarga, Daulatabad, Berar, and Bidar**.
- **Ahmad Shah I Wali** later shifted the capital to **Bidar** around **1429**.
- The kingdom was divided into **eight tarafs**, or provinces, each ruled by a **tarafdar**.
- Bahmani was a long rival of **Vijayanagara** over the **Raichur doab**, and war and marriage alliances alternated between the two powers.
- **Mahmud Gawan**, the Persian wazir (वज़ीर) under Muhammad Shah III, expanded Bahmani power to the Orissa coast.
- Gawan also introduced land surveys and strict revenue accounting.
- He was executed in **1481** after a forged treason letter, and Bahmani's administrative peak ended with his death.

- Rival **Deccani and Afaqi** noble factions later paralysed the court.
- The last sultan was **Kalimullah**, and the kingdom split in **1518** into five Deccan Sultanates.

Sultan chronology

Sultan	Period	Fact
Alauddin Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu)	1347–1358	Founder at Gulbarga
Muhammad Shah I	1358–1375	Early consolidation
Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Bahmani	1397–1422	Pre-Bidar phase
Ahmad Shah I Wali	1422–1436	Capital shift to **Bidar**
Muhammad Shah III	1463–1482	**Mahmud Gawan** as wazir
Kalimullah	Last sultan	Kingdom split **1518**

Alauddin Bahman Shah / Hasan Gangu (1347–1358)

- **Hasan Gangu** was a Turkish officer in the service of **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** who rebelled and declared independence at **Gulbarga in 1347**.
- He took the throne name **Alauddin Bahman Shah** and founded the first major Muslim kingdom of the Deccan.

Muhammad Shah I (1358–1375)

- **Muhammad Shah I** consolidated the infant Bahmani state after Hasan Gangu.
- He pushed back Vijayanagara pressure and fixed Gulbarga as a durable Deccan capital.

Firoz Shah Bahmani (1397–1422)

- **Firoz Shah Bahmani** ruled through a long phase of wars with **Vijayanagara** over the **Raichur doab**.
- His reign kept Bahmani power intact before the later shift to **Bidar**.

Ahmad Shah I Wali (1422–1436)

- **Ahmad Shah I Wali** moved the Bahmani capital from **Gulbarga** to **Bidar** around **1429**.
- He built fortifications and mosques that made **Bidar** the architectural centre of the kingdom.

Muhammad Shah III (1463–1482)

- **Muhammad Shah III** was a minor when he came to the throne, and real power passed to his minister **Mahmud Gawan**.
- Under this reign Bahmani armies reached the **Konkan**, **Goa**, and the **Orissa coast**.

Kalimullah (last sultan)

- **Kalimullah** was a weak last sultan after Gawan's execution and noble faction fights.
- The kingdom formally broke into **five Deccan Sultanates in 1518**.

Mahmud Gawan (wazir, executed 1481)

Persian-born minister | Wazir under Muhammad Shah III | Author of state letters preserved as *Riyaz-ul-Insha*

- **Mahmud Gawan** was born at **Gawan** in **Persia** and came to the Deccan as a trader before entering Bahmani service.
- He rose through military and diplomatic talent to become **wazir** (वज़ीर) (prime minister) under **Muhammad Shah III**.
- He was **not** the founder of the Bahmani kingdom — **Hasan Gangu** holds that fact.
- As wazir he conquered **Konkan** and **Goa** and extended Bahmani influence toward the **Orissa coast**.
- He introduced **land measurement**, **strict revenue accounting**, **cash salaries**, and **merit-based appointments** in place of hereditary noble privilege.
- He built a famous **madrasa at Bidar** and patronised Persian learning alongside fiscal reform.
- **Riyaz-ul-Insha** preserves his official **letters and state papers** and is a major source on Bahmani administration.
- Rival nobles forged a **treason letter** in his name; the sultan ordered his execution in **1481**.
- After Gawan's death, **Deccani** and **Afaqi** noble factions paralysed the court and the kingdom declined toward the **1518** split.

Administration

Office	Function
Wazir	Prime minister and head of civil administration
Mustaufi	Finance minister; accounts and audit
Mir Jumla	Foreign trade (पण्याध्यक्ष), customs, and commercial revenue
Tarafdar	Governor of a **taraf** (province)
Kotwal	City administration and law and order
Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक)	Intelligence service and news reporting
Ariz	Military department; army rolls and pay

- The kingdom was divided into **eight tarafs** (provinces), each under a **tarafdar**.
- Important taraf centres included **Daulatabad**, **Gulbarga**, **Bidar**, **Berar**, and the **Telangana** belt.
- Bahmani administration used a **Persianate centralised bureaucracy** adapted from the Delhi Sultanate model.
- Revenue came from **land tax**, **trade dues**, and **tribute** from subordinated chiefs.
- Weak tarafdars later broke away as the independent **Deccan Sultanates** after **1518**.

Literary and historical sources

Work	What it is	Key fact
Riyaz-ul-Insha	Collection of **Mahmud Gawan's letters and state papers**	Bahmani administration; **not** Bengal history
Riyaz-us-Salatin	History of **Bengal**	Trap: sounds like Riyaz-ul-Insha but is a **different book**
Burhan-e-Masir	Chronicle of **Ahmadnagar**	Nizam Shahi successor state, not Bahmani court letters
Mirat-e-Sikandari	**Gujarat** victory narrative	Regional history; match with Gujarat

> **Logic: Hasan Gangu** founded the Bahmani Kingdom; **Mahmud Gawan** was a minister. **Mirat-e-Sikandari** narrates the **Gujarat** victory; **Burhan-e-Masir** covers **Ahmadnagar**; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** is **Bengal** history; **Riyaz-ul-Insha** collects **Gawan's** letters.

> [!TIP]

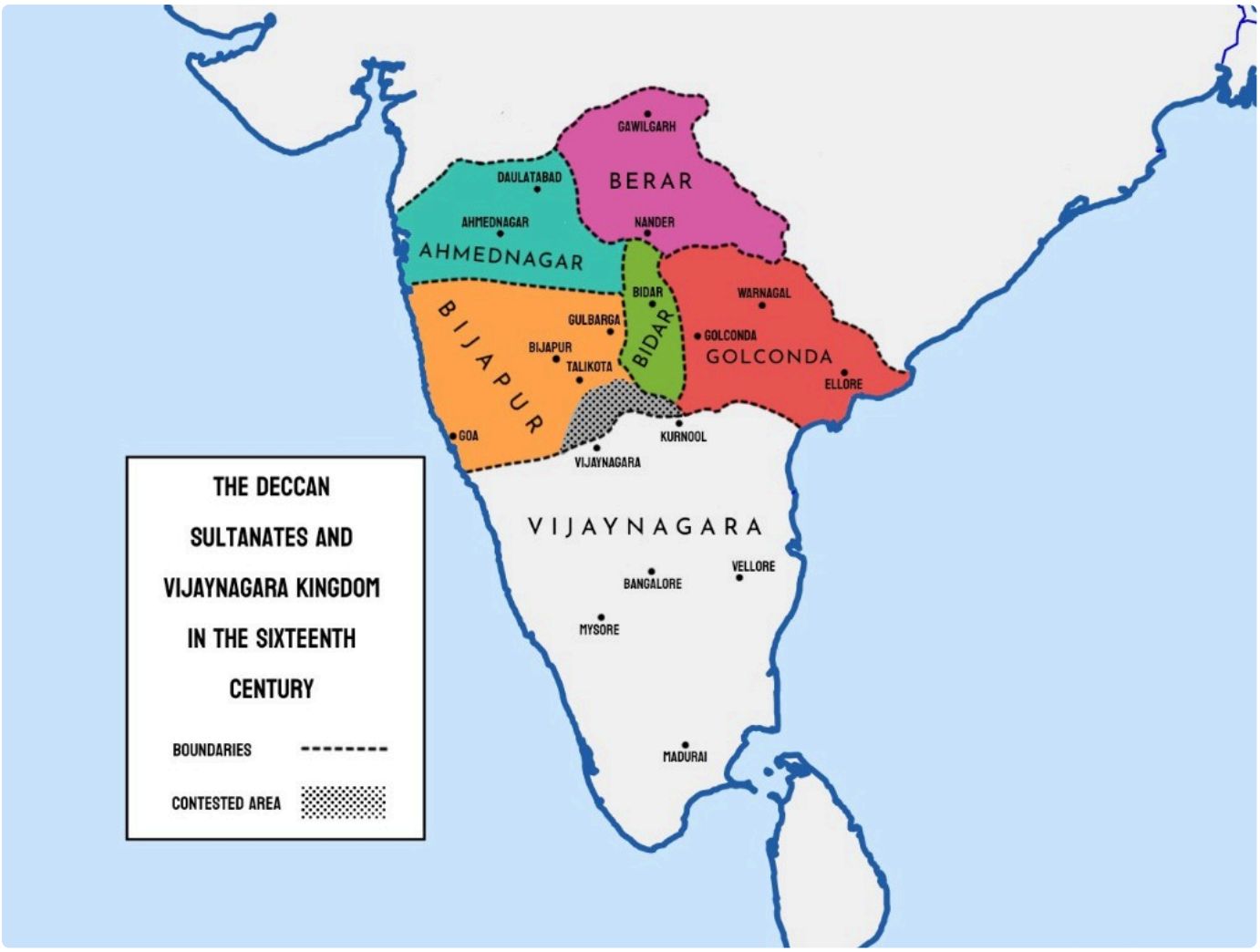
> **Exam Anchor [Bahmani — Mahmud Gawan]:** Mahmud Gawan (*Khwaja Jahan*), prime minister under Muhammad Shah III, divided the 4 Bahmani tarafs into 8 smaller administrative units and established the famous **Madrasa at Bidar (1472)**. *(See Bahmani section below)*

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q33]:** Historical texts & regional contexts: *Mirat-e-Sikandari* = Gujarat (Sikandar bin Muhammad); *Burhan-e-Masir* = Ahmadnagar/Nizam Shahi (Ali bin Azizullah Tabataba); *Riyaz-us-Salatin* = Bengal (Ghulam Husain Salim); *Tazkirat-ul-Muluk* = Bijapur (Rafiuddin Shirazi). *(See Q5 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

3.5 Deccan Sultanates

Five successor states (from ~1518) | All used **Persianate** central administration modelled on the Bahmani system



Sultanate	Dynasty	Founder	Capital	Period
Bijapur (बीजापुर)	Adil Shahi	**Yusuf Adil Shah** (यूसुफ आदिल)	Bijapur	1490–1686
Golkonda	Qutb Shahi	**Quli Qutb Shah**	Golkonda → Hyderabad	1518–1687
Ahmadnagar	Nizam Shahi	**Malik Ahmad** (मलिक अहमद)	Ahmadnagar	1490–1636
Bidar	Barid Shahi	**Amir Barid**	Bidar	1492–1619
Berar	Imad Shahi	**Fathullah Imad-ul-Mulk**	Ellichpur	1490–1574

Common administrative pattern

Element	Function
Wazir / Peshwa (पेशवा)	Chief minister
Pargana (परगना)	Basic revenue-admin unit
Amil / Desai (आमिल)	Revenue collector
Qazi (क़ाज़ी)	Judge under Islamic law
Kotwal	City police and order

- All five states inherited the Bahmani **taraf** idea but ruled as separate sultanates after **1518**.
- Land revenue, trade customs, and feudatory tribute remained the main income sources.
- Four of them — **Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golkonda, and Bidar** — united against **Vijayanagara** at **Talikota (1565)**.
- The Mughals later absorbed them: **Ahmadnagar (1636)**, **Bijapur (1686)**, **Golkonda (1687)**.

Bijapur (Adil Shahi)

- **Yusuf Adil Shah** founded the **Adil Shahi** line at **Bijapur** after the Bahmani collapse — **not** Ahmadnagar (**Nizam Shahi** = **Malik Ahmad**).
- **Ismail Adil Shah** was defeated by **Krishnadevaraya** at **Raichur (1520)**.
- **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** wrote **Kitab-i-Nauras** (Deccani), founded musical city **Nauraspur**, and was hailed **Jagatguru** and **Ablababa** (friend of the poor). **Firishta** completed *Tarikh-i-Firishta* in this milieu.
- **Muhammad Adil Shah** built **Gol Gumbaz** (गोल गुम्बद), famous for having one of the world's largest domes.
- Bijapur remained a major Deccan power until Aurangzeb annexed it in **1686**.

Golkonda (Qutb Shahi)

- **Quli Qutb Shah** founded the **Qutb Shahi** dynasty and ruled from **Golkonda fort**.
- **Golkonda** was famous for **diamond mines** and overseas trade links.
- **Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah** founded **Hyderabad in 1591** and built the **Charminar**.
- **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah** was the **last** ruler when Aurangzeb captured Golkonda in **1687**.

Ahmadnagar (Nizam Shahi)

- **Malik Ahmad** founded the **Nizam Shahi** kingdom with capital at **Ahmadnagar**.
- **Hussain Nizam Shah I** joined the anti-Vijayanagara coalition (गठबंधन) at **Talikota (1565)**.
- The court chronicle **Burhan-e-Masir** records Ahmadnagar history.
- The Mughals annexed Ahmadnagar in **1636** under **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ); **Hussain Nizam Shah III** was imprisoned for life (Gwalior) after **Fateh Khan** surrendered **Daulatabad**.

Bidar (Barid Shahi)

- **Amir Barid** was a former Bahmani minister who founded the **Barid Shahi** state at **Bidar**.
- **Tin Darwaza** in **Bidar Fort** is the standard monument fact for this centre.
- Bidar remained smaller than Bijapur and Golkonda and was absorbed by Bijapur in **1619**.

Berar (Imad Shahi)

- **Fathullah Imad-ul-Mulk** founded the **Imad Shahi** line at **Ellichpur** in **Berar**.
- Berar was the **smallest** of the five successor states and was absorbed early by other Deccan powers.
- It rarely appears alone in match lists but completes the **five-sultanate** count after **1518**.

Literary works of the Deccan Sultanates

Work	Author / state	Key fact
Kitab-i-Nauras	**Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of **Bijapur**	Musical-devotional songs; **not** Krishnadevaraya
Burhan-e-Masir	Court chronicle of **Ahmadnagar**	Nizam Shahi history
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadevaraya** of Vijayanagara	Telugu epic — cross-trap with Kitab-i-Nauras

> **Logic:** Do not confuse **Bidar**, the Bahmani and later Barid Shahi centre, with **Bijapur**, the Adil Shahi capital. **Kitab-i-Nauras** was written by **Ibrahim Adil Shah II of Bijapur**, not by Krishnadevaraya.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q44]:** *Kitab-i-Nauras* was authored by **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of Bijapur (*Jagat Guru / Abla Baba*). *(See Q4 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q34) Who was the ruler of Golkonda when Aurangzeb seized the fort of Golkonda in **1687**?

A. Abul Hasan Qutb Shah B. Sikandar Adil Shah C. Ali Adil Shah II D. Shayasta Khan

Show answer

Ans: A. **Why:** Abul Hasan Qutb Shah was the **last Qutb Shahi** ruler when Aurangzeb captured Golkonda in **1687**. **Trap:** Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah** founded **Hyderabad** and built **Charminar (1591)** — he ruled **a century earlier**, not in 1687.

3.6 Battle of Talikota (1565) (तालीकोटा)

Date:23 January 1565 | **Site:Rakkasa-Tangadi** (near Talikota)

- **Cause:** Aliya Rama Raya**, the Vijayanagara regent, repeatedly meddled in Deccan Sultanate successions and alienated all four major successor states.
- **Course:** On **23 January 1565**, the four sultanates formed a coalition against Vijayanagara at **Rakkasa-Tangadi** near Talikota.
- The coalition included **Bijapur under Ali Adil Shah I**, **Ahmadnagar under Hussain Nizam Shah I**, **Golkonda under Ibrahim Qutb Shah**, and **Bidar under Ali Barid**.
- **Rama Raya** was captured and **beheaded** on the battlefield, and the Vijayanagara army collapsed.
- **Result:** Hampi was looted for about six months and the old capital was abandoned.
- The **Aravidu** dynasty retreated to **Penukonda and Chandragiri**, while **nayakas** became independent in Madurai, Tanjore, and Gingee.
- Talikota ended Vijayanagara as a **great power**, even though the empire survived in name until **1646**.

> **Logic:** Talikota (1565) is not the same as **Raichur (1520)**, which was Krishnadevaraya's victory. **Rama Raya** was killed at Talikota; Krishnadevaraya had died in **1529**.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [Battle of Talikota (1565)]:** Fought on **23 January 1565** (Rakshasi-Tangadi / Bannihatti); alliance of Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golkonda, Bidar defeated Vijayanagara; **Aliya Rama Raya** captured and beheaded; **Berar** did NOT participate. *(See Ghatna Chakra Vijayanagara bank below)*

3.7 Master Fact-Locks — Medieval Geography, Regional Architecture & Polygars

Topic / Category	Entity / Detail	Region / Present State / Notes
Medieval State	**Champaka (Chamba)**	Himachal Pradesh (Rajput state emerging post-Tripartite struggle)
Medieval State	**Kuluta (Kullu)**	Himachal Pradesh (Rajput state emerging post-Tripartite struggle)
Medieval State	**Durgara**	Jammu & Kashmir (Rajput state)
South Indian Feudalism	**Polygars (Palaiyakkarar)**	Territorial administrative & military governors appointed by **Nayaka rulers** of South India (16th–18th c.)
Mandu (Malwa)	**Jahaj Mahal**	Built by **Ghiyasuddin Khalji** in Mandu (*Exam Clarification:* NO 'Jantar Mahal' exists in Mandu)
Bengal Architecture	**Adina Masjid**	Located at **Pandua**, West Bengal; built by Sultan **Sikandar Shah** (1364–1374 CE)
Bengal Architecture	**Qadam Rasul**	Built by Sultan **Nusrat Shah** at Gaur
Bengal Architecture	**Chhota Sona Masjid**	Built by **Wali Muhammad** at Gaur
Gujarat Architecture	**Tin Darwaza**	Triple-arched ceremonial gate in Ahmedabad built by **Ahmad Shah I** (1415 CE)
Gwalior Architecture	**Gujari Mahal**	Built by Raja **Man Singh Tomar** (1486–1516 CE); currently converted into a museum
Mewar Court Scholars	**Court of Rana Kumbha**	Scholars: **Muni Sunder Suri**, **Natha**, **Tilla Bhatt** (*Trap:* Muni Jin Vijay Suri was in Akbar's court, NOT Kumbha's)
Structural Typology	**Double Dome**	Sikandar Lodi Tomb / Humayun's Tomb

Topic / Category	Entity / Detail	Region / Present State / Notes
Structural Typology	**Octagonal Tomb**	Tomb of Sher Shah Suri (Sasaram)
Structural Typology	**True Arch Tomb**	Tomb of Balban (Delhi)
Structural Typology	**World's Largest Dome**	Gol Gumbad of Muhammad Adil Shah (Bijapur)